

Frequency Basics

A Quick-Reference Guide

Main Terms

100%	Always	
>0%	Often	(sometimes more than >50% but not always)
>0%	Sometimes	(sometimes less than <50% but not always)
0%	Never	

Examples

Always	Often	Sometimes	Never
It always rains in spring.	It is often very hot in summer.	It sometimes snows in spring.	It is never very hot in winter.
She always eats breakfast in the morning.	He often eats rice for lunch.	They sometimes eat fish for lunch.	I never eat breakfast for dinner.
He always talks with his friends.	I often talk with friends about games.	She sometimes cooks dinner with her friends.	I never cook breakfast with my friends.
Fish always live in water.	Birds often eat under water.	Fish sometimes jump into the air.	Birds never live under water.

Frequency Term Chart

Chance	Term
100:100	always (sarcasm: never)
95-100:100	almost always, just about always, often, very often, frequently, almost every X
[more than 50%]	usually, normally, most of the time, typically, generally, ordinarily, regularly, (on) most days,
40-100: 100	usually, often, normally, commonly, periodically, always (casual),
15-85:100	sometimes, occasionally (usually less than 50% but not always)
1-30:100	rarely, seldom, sometimes, occasionally, from time to time, hardly ever,
1-10:100	almost never, very rarely, quite seldom, don't often, don't normally, just about never
0:100	never (sarcasm: always)